HEATHER ROD

BLOOMINGTON, IL | RODHEATHER23@GMAIL.COM | 309.808.9719

Creative communication analyst championing data literacy and user-centric strategy. Proven success applying human-centered design to audience insights, developing intuitive analytics dashboards, and pioneering approaches that drive personalized and transparent audience engagement and transform communication culture. Mostly I'm passionate about learning and understanding the world around me, and connecting with others through shared experiences and finding common ground.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

COMMUNICATIONS ANALYST

05.2024 – Present

STATE FARM | BLOOMINGTON, IL

- Developed Power BI and Adobe Analytics dashboards to enable greater understanding of audiences and content performance, empowering communicators to independently and confidently apply data and insights.
- Redesigned catastrophe communication feedback loops using open-response metrics during high-stakes events, resulting in overwhelmingly positive response and increased employee perception of enterprise transparency.
- Researched and co-developed internal channels benchmarking and an effective internal communication framework alongside senior peers and leaders to align with industry best practices.

PUBLIC AFFAIRS SPECIALIST

07.2023 – 05.2024

STATE FARM | BLOOMINGTON, IL

- Researched and reported for SFnet News and assumed ownership of quarterly reporting for internal channels.
- Collaborated with project group to develop comprehensive Audience Communication Profiles, equipping communicators to understand unique audience needs and deliver personalized, relevant messaging.

DIGITAL MANAGER

08.2020 – 07.2023

ILLINOIS SOYBEAN ASSOCIATION | BLOOMINGTON, IL

- Pioneered digital marketing and analytics standards and practices among soybean associations, connecting 43,000 farmers to the work of the organization through multiple digital channels.
- Coordinated, directed, and collaborated with external contractors and internal stakeholders on multiple concurrent organizational and departmental projects, delivering visible value to constituents.
- Launched and grew internship program and provided company-wide HR/IT services during leadership vacancies, demonstrating accountability and adaptability through periods of disruption and uncertainty.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE: Digital & Support Services Coordinator (ISA, 2019-2020) • HR Recruiter (The Kelly Group, 2018) • Total Rewards Specialist (Pekin Insurance, 2017-2018) • HR & Mktg Assistant; HR Coordinator; HR Manager (Skill Sprout, 2014-2017) • Business Co-Owner & Manager (Nacho Mama's Grilled Cheese, 2013-2017)

CORE COMPETENCIES

DATA & ANALYTICS:
Power BI, Adobe Analytics, Excel

STRATEGIC SKILLS:
Creative Problem Solving, Research and Measurement, Design Thinking, User Experience

DIGITAL PLATFORMS:
Drupal, WordPress, Mailchimp, HubSpot, Sprout, Canva, Staffbase, Gemini, GitHub

LEADERSHIP & AFFILIATIONS

PRIDE BUSINESS RESOURCE GROUP

STATE FARM | 07.2023 – PRESENT

- **2026 Bloomington Area Engagement Ambassador:** Collaborate with BRG leaders to connect LGBTQ+ employees and allies with each other, the enterprise, and the broader community.
- **2025-2026 Business Pillar Support:** Coordinate content and logistics for quarterly all-member meetings, support and host virtual events, and develop resources to drive engagement and organizational alignment.

EDUCATION

BACHELOR OF ARTS, COMMUNICATION | Eureka College | Eureka, IL CLASS OF 2011